

I am mostly drawn to Literature in its ability to address pertinent social issues and use environmental influences to build the distinctive world of the text. It is particularly stimulating to explore controversial characters and appreciate the ingenuity within literary technique.

English Literature at A Level has been enjoyable so far, specifically in my comparison of Webster's 'The Duchess of Malfi' and Milton's 'Paradise Lost'. While Webster conveys the heroic transgression of the Duchess, rebelling against the control of her perverse brothers, Milton contrarily portrays Eve as a woman who is blameworthy for her own fall, seduced by language of social ambition and status - 'empress of this fair world'. Both texts display how the overconsumption of gender and power in the hands of a female protagonist induces an inevitable dramatic downfall in the 17th century, contextually relating to women's struggle for sexual autonomy. I am enthused by the conflicting didacticism of the societal patriarchy presented in each text. At degree level, I would like to expand my knowledge of literature's societal contexts across extensive periods of time.

Beyond the curriculum of my dystopian studies, I read 'The Machine Stops' which demonstrates Forster's brilliant insight into human nature as he predicts how humans have succumb to modern technology. This led me to read his magnum opus: 'A Passage to India', justly considered ahead of its time in its discussion of power imbalance and colonialism. Moreover, reading 'A Room with a View' has confirmed my admiration for his works, as he digresses from more sober ideals of the Victorian era by addressing the divisive boundaries of social class. E.M. Forster is a master of character and societal analysis, often using personal experience, such as physical locations of India and Italy, to influence his writings. I greatly admire his use of straightforward prose and chronology, building different worlds throughout his novels.

In reading 'A Clockwork Orange' by Anthony Burgess, parallels with Nabokov's acclaimed novel 'Lolita' became evident. Both authors use a first-person narrative to evoke the reader's empathy, despite the repulsive acts of the powerful male protagonists. Literary technique serves as a gateway to a personal deliberation on morality. I enjoy such controversial novels as it stimulates debate, and I am excited to discuss these with people who share the same interest.

I often read poetry for pleasure and my recent discovery of Thom Gunn has established this affinity. In his anthology 'The Man with Night Sweats', the elegy 'Lament' had struck me with its emotive repetition of death being a "difficult enterprise". The sterile noun "enterprise" initially reveals emotional restraint, as sentiments are frequently interrupted by physical realities.

Gunn masterfully applies traditional poetic mechanisms to his nonconforming life. I am eager to reach a breadth of distinguished poets and appreciate their works in greater detail.

Outside of academia, my main interests lie in performing arts, hence my relish for English. I have been professionally trained in acting with LAMDA examiners and performed in the sixth form play 'Class' as the lead, which has helped in developing my close reading skills. Being an avid speaker in Debate Society and Westminster Cathedral has allowed me to freely express creative ideas, advancing my capacity to discuss literature. As a young author, writing for Oremus magazine, 'Winter Festival' created by Susannah de Fère and Papatangos 'GoWrite' scheme, I have experienced the process of formulating published works, thus improving my ability to write about other texts.

On the course, I would like to improve my critical analysis and select modules reflective of my interests, such as sexuality. I look forward to making an individual contribution to the vast study of literature.

